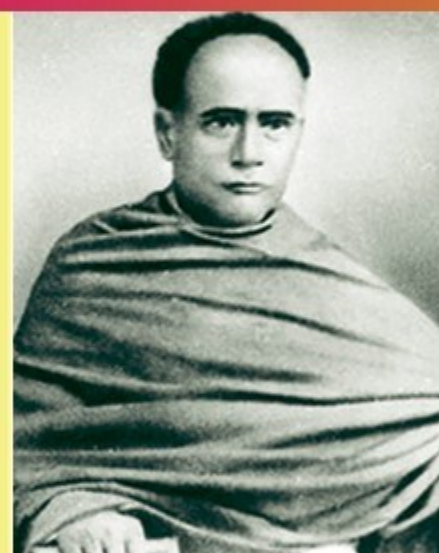
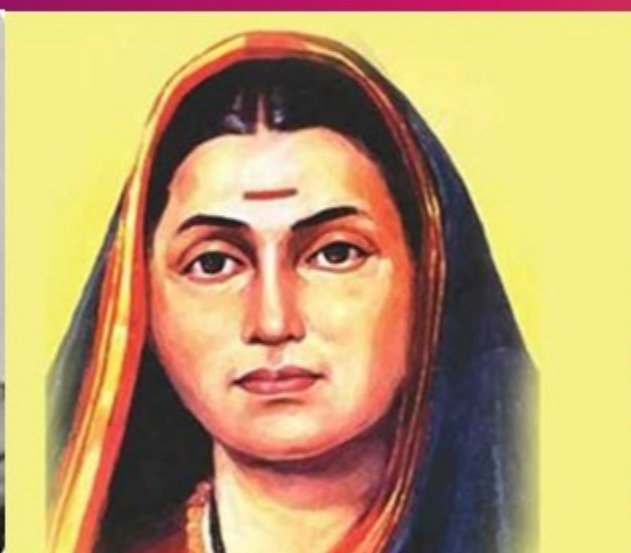


# MODERN INDIAN HISTORY



**MODULE - 5**

**SOCIO-RELIGIOUS REFORMS**  
**PART-5**

# SIGNIFICANT MOVEMENTS

**SOCIO-REFORM MOVEMENTS**

**WORKING CLASS MOVEMENTS**

**REVOLUTIONARY MOVEMENTS**

**REVOLT OF 1857**

**PEASANTS MOVEMENTS**

**LEFTISTS MOVEMENTS**

**TRIBAL MOVEMENTS**

## SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

We can study socio-religious movements under nine divisions-

**SOCIAL REFORM MOVEMENTS**

**HINDU REFORM MOVEMENTS**

**OTHER SECULAR/ NON- HINDU  
REFORM MOVEMENTS**

**PARSI REFORM MOVEMENTS**

**ANTI-UNTOUCHABILITY MOVEMENTS**

**SIKH MOVEMENTS**

**ISLAMIC REFORM MOVEMENTS**

**DEPRESSED CASTE MOVEMENTS**

**MOVEMENTS FOR THE EMANCIPATION OF WOMEN**



## DEPRESSED CLASSES MOVEMENT OF B R AMBEDKAR



B R AMBEDKAR

Belonged to the untouchable Mahar caste

In 1924 Dr. Ambedkar founded the **Depressed Classes Institute (Bahishkrit Hitkarini Sabha)** in Bombay.

In 1927—

- he started a Marathi fortnightly, **Bahishkrit Bharat**,
- he established **Samaj Samta Sangh** to propagate the gospel of social equality between caste Hindus and untouchables
- he led the **Mahad Satyagraha** to establish the rights of untouchables to draw water from public wells and tanks

He also organised temple entry movements like the **Parvati temple satyagraha of 1928** and the **Kalasam temple satyagraha of 1930-35**.

*Ambedkar also organised the Independent Labour Party on secular lines for protecting the interest of the labouring classes.*



## DEPRESSED CLASSES MOVEMENT OF B R AMBEDKAR

Both Gandhi and Ambedkar were great social reformers and political leaders and strove for the improvement of the cause of depressed classes. However, both had **fundamental differences**—

## GANDHIJI VIEWS ON CASTE SYSTEM

Gandhi wanted to **reform caste system** by changing the hearts and minds of high Castes. He did not support the abolition of caste system or Varnashrama order.

Gandhi had great **appreciation of Hindu Dharma** particularly its qualities of **toleration and adjustment**.

Gandhi believed that **such movement may be launched by any person**.

His programmes were **intended to development and economic upliftment** of people by making them self-reliant.

## AMBEDKARJI VIEWS ON CASTE SYSTEM

Ambedkar was in favour of **annihilation of caste system** as it was beyond reforms.

Ambedkar **equated Hinduism with Brahmanism**

Ambedkar believed that the movement for the amelioration of the cause of depressed classes cannot be launched by high castes. It **should be led by depressed classes only**

His programmes were **intended to integrate untouchables into Indian society based on education, legal and political rights**.



## DEPRESSED CLASSES MOVEMENT OF B R AMBEDKAR

Ambedkar had concluded in 1930s that the only way of improving the status of untouchables was to renounce Hindu religion, and gave the slogan **“You have nothing to lose except your religion.”**

He **took a separatist stand and demanded constitutional safeguards** for the depressed classes.

The untouchables demanded separate electorates in the 1930s, which led to a conflict between Ambedkar and Gandhiji which was later resolved through **Poona Pact**.

In 1942 Ambedkar founded the **Scheduled Caste Federation**. The Federation fought for the reserved seats in the 1946 elections but lost heavily to ‘Congress Harijans’.

In the 1950s he **embraced Buddhism**.

*Ambedkar criticised Gandhism in the following words, “Gandhism is the philosophy of well to do and the leisure class.” It deluded people into accepting their misfortunes by presenting them as best of good fortunes. Gandhism seeks to perpetuate the system of scavenging as the noblest service to society. But these are the evils that are deliberately imposed by one class over another.*

# SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

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**MOVEMENTS FOR THE EMANCIPATION OF WOMEN**



## INDIVIDUAL ACTIVISTS



RAJA RAM MOHAN ROY

Campaigned for abolition of  
**Sati practice**



ISHWAR CHANDRA VIDYASAGAR

Efforts of him led to enactment of  
**Widow Remarriage Act in 1856.**



JED BETHUNE

He was a British law member  
of Governor General's Council

He established a school for girls {Hindu Kanya Vidyalaya} in 1849 in Calcutta. This was later known as Bethune school. One student of this school Kadambini Ganguly joined Calcutta Medical College as the first Indian girl student of a medical college and later she became first practicing lady doctor in India.



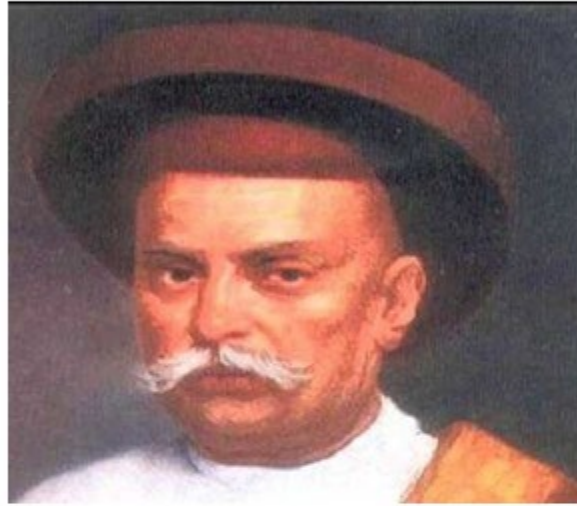


## INDIVIDUAL ACTIVISTS



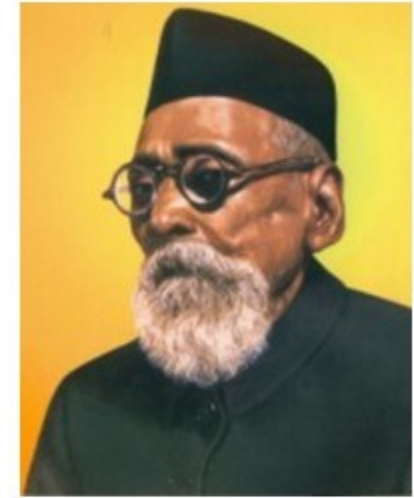
VIRASALINGAM PANTULU

Campaigned for **widow remarriage and female education**. He also launched **anti-nautch movement** (against hiring of dancing girls for celebrations).



MAHADEV GOVIND RANADE

- Founded the **Widow Remarriage Association** and encouraged widow remarriage and female education and opposed child marriage.
- Founded **National Social Conference**.
- His **wife Ramabai ranade** founded the **Seva Sadan**, a school for widows.



DHONDO KESHAV KARVE

Founded the **female school and widow homes** in Pune and **first Indian women's university** in 1916.



RAMABAI RANADE

**BHARAT MAHILA PARISHAD**

It was a **part of the National Social Conference** to provide a forum for the discussion of social issues organised by Ramabai Ranade.

**THE ARYA MAHILA SAMAJ**

It was **founded by Ramabai**, wife of Justice Ranade, to provide a support network for newly educated women.



## 9 MOVEMENTS FOR THE EMANCIPATION OF WOMEN

### ASSOCIATIONS FOR THE WOMEN

#### BHARAT STREE MAHAMANDAL, 1910

**SARALA DEVI  
CHAUDHURANI**

#WOMENFREEDOMFIGHTERS



SHE WAS GRAND DAUGHTER OF  
DEBENDRANATH TAGORE

It was the **first women's organisation in India** founded by Sarala Devi Chaudhurani in Allahabad.

One of the primary goals of the organisation was to **promote female education**. **Purdah** was regarded by Sarala Devi as the main obstacle for women's education and teachers were sent round to women's homes to educate them.

Organisation opened several offices in Lahore, Allahabad, Delhi, Karachi, Amritsar etc. to improve the condition of women all over India.

## ASSOCIATIONS FOR THE WOMEN

THE WOMEN'S INDIAN  
ASSOCIATION, 1915

Founded by an **Irish feminist and theosophist**, Dorothy Jinarajadasa. Annie Besant became its first President.

Membership was open to both Indians and Europeans.

The principal work of the WIA was educational **upliftment of women**.

THE NATIONAL COUNCIL OF WOMEN  
FOR INDIA, 1925

It was an **all-India organisation** which was affiliated to the International Council of Women.

**Mehribai Tata (wife of Dorab Tata)** played a key role in its advancement





## 9 MOVEMENTS FOR THE EMANCIPATION OF WOMEN

### ASSOCIATIONS FOR THE WOMEN

#### THE ALL-INDIA WOMEN'S CONFERENCE (AIWC), 1927



Founded by Margret Cousins having Sarojni Naidu, Lady Dorab Tata as its founding members.

It worked towards women's education, abolition of purdah system, legislative reform, abolition of child marriage, harijan welfare, family planning, and rural reconstruction.

Their efforts led to several legislative reforms in Sarda Act (1929) (by efforts of Harbilas Sarda), Hindu Women's Right to Property Act (1937), Factory Act (1947), Hindu Marriage and Divorce Act etc.

*Child Marriage Restraint Act commonly known as Sarda Act was passed in 1929 which raised the marriageable age for girls to 14 and for boys to 18 years.*

# SOCIAL REFORMS MOVEMENTS

## LEGISLATIONS



1765-1858

### UNDER THE COMPANY RULE

1829

BENGAL SATI REGULATION,  
1829

1843

THE INDIAN SLAVERY ACT'

1850

'REMOVAL OF THE CASTE  
DISABILITY ACT'

1856

'WIDOW REMARRIAGE ACT'

1858- 1947



### UNDER THE BRITISH CROWN

1929

Child Marriage Restraint Act  
commonly known as **Sharda  
Act** was passed in 1929  
which raised the  
marriageable age for girls to  
14 and for boys to 18 years.



RAI SAHIB HARBILAS SARADA



# SIGNIFICANT MOVEMENTS

**SOCIO-REFORM MOVEMENTS**

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